

Please enter what you learned from today's lecture in at least 30 words.

Today, I learned the basics of relational databases and how to write SQL queries to efficiently extract and manage large amounts of data. We used DuckDB in Google Colab to practice creating tables, inserting data, and using commands like SELECT, WHERE, GROUP BY, and JOIN. I also learned some really helpful advanced feature engineering techniques for the NFL competition, like creating a speed score and using SMOTE for imbalanced data.

Please provide specific details about what you particularly liked about today's lecture.

I really liked the competition tips at the end. The instructor went over practical ways to improve our models, such as combining weight and sprint times into a synthetic "speed score" and using the Optuna library for hyperparameter tuning with CatBoost. That will definitely help me improve my leaderboard score.

If there were any parts that were unclear or areas for improvement, please provide specific details.

The time management could be a little better. The SQL implementation part was super rushed towards the end, and the instructor had to skip over giving us time to do the practice questions ourselves because we had to hurry to the competition tips.

Regarding the instructor, please provide specific details about what you liked or disliked.

I liked that the instructor shared real-world industry perspectives, like showing us how messy actual bank transaction databases are and explaining why the ETL (Extract, Transform, Load) process is so critical before doing any data science. He was very knowledgeable, though I would suggest pacing the lecture material slightly better.

Please write down any lectures or fields you would like to attend in the future.

I would love to have a deeper dive into hyperparameter tuning libraries like Optuna, and maybe learn some more advanced SQL concepts since the instructor mentioned that industry problems usually require a strong grasp of the basics first.

Please feel free to write any other comments or opinions.

Thanks for the announcement regarding the final assignment! Allowing late submissions until July 8th really helps take some of the pressure off right now, even if it means we won't be eligible for the outstanding student selection.